PEARSON EDEXCEL GCSE (9–1) HISTORY TEACHER MARK SCHEME

Predicted Radar Mock Paper

Paper 2: Conflict in the Middle East, 1945–1995 (Option P5) • 32 Marks Total

🎯 **Specification Gap: Key Topic 2.1 (Cairo Conference 1964 & Growth of Fatah/PLO — Exam count: 0)**

Question 1 (a): Explain one consequence of the Cairo Conference (1964). [4 Marks]

Target: AO1 (demonstrate knowledge and understanding) & AO2 (explain cause and consequence).
Level 2 (3–4 Marks): Specific factual explanation demonstrating a direct, supported consequence using precise causation.
Level 1 (1–2 Marks): Simple or general statement of a consequence with limited contextual development.

Exemplar Model Answer (Level 2 — 4 Marks):

One major consequence of the Cairo Conference in January 1964 was the institutional creation of the Palestine Liberation Organization (PLO) to unite disparate Palestinian factions under an official political banner. At the summit, Arab leaders led by Egyptian President Gamal Abdel Nasser agreed to create a representative body for Palestinians, leading directly to the First Palestinian National Council meeting in East Jerusalem in May 1964. As a result, Palestinian nationalism transitioned from scattered refugee committees into an internationally recognized political entity with its own constitution (the Palestinian National Charter) and military wing (the Palestine Liberation Army). This gave Palestinians an autonomous voice on the world stage, although it also initially allowed Arab states like Egypt to supervise and direct Palestinian resistance until Yasser Arafat's independent Fatah guerrilla movement took control of the PLO leadership after 1967.

🎯 Specification Gap: Key Topic 2.3 (Israel's consolidation of control of occupied territories — Exam count: 0)

Question 1 (b): Explain one consequence of Israel's consolidation of control of the occupied territories in the years immediately following 1967. [4 Marks]

Target: AO1 & AO2. Mark out of 4 using the standard Edexcel 2-level tariff.

Exemplar Model Answer (Level 2 — 4 Marks):
One significant consequence of Israel's consolidation of control over the occupied territories after the Six Day War was the establishment of Israeli Jewish settlements across the West Bank, Gaza, and the Golan Heights, creating deep territorial and political friction with Palestinian residents. Following the 1967 victory, the Israeli government began expropriating land and providing state subsidies for Jewish civilian settlements, beginning with the Allon Plan which sought to create defensive security buffers along the Jordan Valley. As a direct result, over one million Palestinian Arabs were brought under strict Israeli military administration without political voting rights, while Jewish settlers established fortified towns and checkpoints. This permanently complicated future peace negotiations, as it altered the demographic map of the territories and fueled Palestinian resentment, creating the underlying grievances that later sparked the 1987 First Intifada.

🎯 High Overdue: Key Topic 2.3 (Egyptian relations with superpowers and Israel 1967–73 — Last appeared: 2018)

Question 2: Narrative Account analysing Egyptian relations with the superpowers and Israel in the years 1967–73. [8 Marks]

> **Target:** AO1 (4 marks) & AO2 (4 marks).
> **Level 3 (6–8 Marks):** A sophisticated narrative account that shows clear chronological organisation and explains the causal links between beginning, middle developments, and outcome. Integrates own knowledge beyond the stimulus points.

Level	Marks	Descriptor
Level 3	6–8	Accurate, detailed chronological account analysing the process of change. Causal links between stages are clearly explained. Comprehensive own knowledge included.
Level 2	3–5	Accurate narrative with some chronological sequence and causal explanation. Relies primarily on stimulus with some supporting detail.
Level 1	1–2	Simple descriptive statements without clear narrative flow or causal connections.

Exemplar Model Answer (Level 3 — 8 Marks):
Following Egypt's catastrophic defeat in the Six Day War of 1967, Egyptian relations with both the superpowers and Israel underwent a dramatic transformation driven by a determination to reverse Israeli occupation of the Sinai Peninsula.

Initially, relations between Egypt and the Soviet Union deepened significantly. With Egypt's air force and military infrastructure decimated, President Nasser turned to Moscow for extensive rearmament. The USSR supplied over $2 billion in modern military hardware, including advanced MiG-21 fighters and SAM-2/SAM-3 anti-aircraft missile batteries, accompanied by approximately 15,000 Soviet military advisors. This enabled Egypt to launch the **War of Attrition (1969–70)**, conducting artillery bombardments and commando raids across the Suez Canal against Israel's fortified Bar-Lev Line. However, when Nasser died in September 1970, his successor **Anwar Sadat** grew frustrated with Soviet reluctance to supply offensive strike aircraft capable of attacking deep into Israeli territory.

This frustration triggered a pivotal turning point in superpower relations. In July 1972, Sadat took the calculated gamble of expelling all 15,000 Soviet military advisors from Egypt. While superficially weakening Egypt's military capability, this move was secretly designed to signal to the United States that Egypt was open to diplomatic realignment, provided Washington pressured Israel to withdraw from the Sinai. When the US and Israel remained complacent, assuming Arab forces were too weak to launch a major assault, Sadat coordinated a joint offensive with President Assad of Syria.

The culmination of this narrative occurred on 6 October 1973 with **Operation Badr**: the surprise crossing of the Suez Canal on the Jewish holiday of Yom Kippur. Egyptian forces breached the Bar-Lev Line with high-pressure water cannons and established defensive bridgeheads under an umbrella of mobile SAM missile batteries, inflicting heavy losses on Israeli counter-attacks. Although

Israel eventually rallied and crossed to the west bank of the canal, the war completely shattered the myth of Israeli military invincibility. Crucially, it forced US Secretary of State Henry Kissinger into active 'shuttle diplomacy', ultimately initiating the diplomatic peace process that led directly to the Camp David Accords.

🎯 **Specification Gap Radar: Explain Two of Three Options (Each marked out of 8, Total = 16 Marks)**

Question 3: Explain the Importance of Two of the Following: [16 Marks Total]

> **Target:** AO1 & AO2 (16 marks total • 8 marks per chosen option). Candidates must answer exactly TWO options.

Option A: The importance of Nasser's leadership of the Arab world for growing tension between Israel and Egypt in the years 1955–56. [8 Marks]

Exemplar Model Answer (Level 3 — 8 Marks):
Nasser's emergence as the undisputed champion of pan-Arab nationalism was critically important for escalating Israeli-Egyptian tensions because it challenged Western dominance and intensified border militarisation.

Firstly, Nasser's determination to modernize Egypt's military led directly to the **Czech Arms Deal in September 1955**. Frustrated by Western restrictions on weapons sales, Nasser bypassed the Tripartite Declaration and agreed to purchase over 200 Soviet MiG-15 jets and hundreds of tanks from Czechoslovakia in exchange for Egyptian cotton. This drastically altered the regional balance of power, sparking acute security panic in Israel, where Prime Minister David Ben-Gurion feared that Egypt would soon launch a war of annihilation once Egyptian pilots were trained on Soviet hardware.

Secondly, Nasser actively supported *fedayeen* commando raids into southern Israel from the Egyptian-administered Gaza Strip, portraying himself as the protector of Palestinian refugees. Israel retaliated with massive military reprisals, most notably the February 1955 Gaza Raid. When the US subsequently withdrew funding for the Aswan High Dam, Nasser responded on 26 July 1956 by nationalising the Suez Canal and imposing a blockade on Israeli shipping through the Straits of Tiran. This direct economic strangulation of Israel's southern port of Eilat provided the decisive catalyst for Israel to conspire secretly with Britain and France in the **Protocol of Sèvres**, triggering the Suez War in October 1956.

Option B: The importance of Arafat's speech to the UN (1974) for international recognition of the Palestinian cause. [8 Marks]

Exemplar Model Answer (Level 3 — 8 Marks):
Yasser Arafat's address to the United Nations General Assembly on 13 November 1974 was of paramount importance because it fundamentally shifted international perception of the Palestinian conflict from a humanitarian refugee dilemma into a legitimate national self-determination struggle.

Firstly, the speech provided the PLO with unprecedented global diplomatic legitimacy. Arafat became the first representative of a non-state entity to address the General Assembly, invited following the Arab League's Rabat Summit declaration that the PLO was the 'sole legitimate representative of the Palestinian people'. Wearing a holster and carrying an olive branch, Arafat famously concluded: *'I have come bearing an olive branch and a freedom fighter's gun. Do not let the olive branch fall from my hand.'* This iconic imagery resonated powerfully across the Non-Aligned Movement and the

Communist bloc.

Secondly, the immediate consequence was **UN Resolution 3236 and 3237**, which reaffirmed the inalienable rights of the Palestinian people to self-determination, national independence, and sovereignty in Palestine, while granting the PLO official Permanent Observer status at the UN. This diplomatic breakthrough marginalized extreme rejectionist groups by showing that political diplomacy could achieve global standing, establishing a foundation that later allowed the PLO to negotiate bilaterally with the United States and Israel during the 1993 Oslo Peace Process.

Option C: The importance of the end of the Cold War and the Gulf War (1991) for superpower peace efforts in the Middle East. [8 Marks]

Exemplar Model Answer (Level 3 — 8 Marks):
The confluence of the Cold War's end and the 1991 Gulf War was decisive in creating an unprecedented diplomatic window that forced both Arab states and Israel to the negotiating table.

Firstly, the collapse of the Soviet Union eliminated the primary military and diplomatic sponsor of radical Arab regimes like Syria and the PLO. Without Soviet subsidies and weaponry, Arab states could no longer contemplate military parity with Israel. Furthermore, the massive exodus of over 400,000 Soviet Jews immigrating to Israel in the early 1990s strained Israel's economy, making Prime Minister Yitzhak Shamir heavily reliant on $10 billion in US loan guarantees, which President George H.W. Bush threatened to withhold unless Israel agreed to attend international peace talks.

Secondly, the 1991 Gulf War transformed regional alliances. When Saddam Hussein invaded Kuwait, the US built a coalition that included Arab states such as Egypt, Saudi Arabia, and Syria. To reward these Arab allies and disprove accusations of double standards, US President Bush and Secretary of State James Baker committed to resolving the Arab-Israeli conflict immediately following the liberation of Kuwait. Meanwhile, the PLO had disastrously backed Saddam Hussein, resulting in the expulsion of 300,000 Palestinians from Kuwait and the cut-off of Gulf financial aid, leaving Arafat isolated and desperate for a diplomatic breakthrough. This unique superpower leverage led directly to the convening of the **Madrid Peace Conference in October 1991**, where Israeli and Arab delegates sat face-to-face for the first time in history.